

1. Datasette Apps: Host custom HTML applications inside Datasette

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-18T23:58:38+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/18/datasette-apps/#atom-everything>

Today we launched a new plugin for Datasette, `datasette-apps`, with this launch announcement post on the Datasette project blog. That post has the what, but I'm going to expand on that a little bit here to provide the why. The TL;DR Datasette Apps are self-contained HTML+JavaScript applications that run in a tightly constrained sandbox hosted on your Datasette application. They can use JavaScript to run read-only SQL queries against data in Datasette, and can run write queries too if you configure them with some stored queries. Here's a very simple example and a more complex custom timeline example - the latter looks like this: Apps are allowed to run JavaScript and render HTML and CSS. They are limited in terms of access - they run in prevents them from accessing cookies or localStorage and they also have an injected CSP header (thanks to this research) which prevents them from making HTTP requests to outside hosts, preventing a malicious or buggy app from exfiltrating private data. Datasette Apps started out as my attempt at building a Claude Artifacts mechanism for Datasette Agent, but I quickly realised that the sandboxed pattern is interesting for way more than just...

2. datasette-acl 0.6a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-18T19:03:13+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/18/datasette-acl/#atom-everything>

Release: `datasette-acl 0.6a0` This release expands `datasette-acl` from table-only permissions toward a general resource-sharing system. Alex Garcia did most of the work for this release - we're fleshing out the plugin that will allow multi-user Datasette instances finely grained control over who can access which resources within Datasette. Tags: `datasette`, `alex-garcia`

3. NetNewsWire Status

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-17T03:36:09+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/17/netnewswire-status/#atom-everything>

NetNewsWire Status I find this inspiring. Brent Simmons retired a year ago, and his retirement project is making one piece of software really, really good - free from any commercial pressure. The software is NetNewsWire - "it's like podcasts, but for reading" - first released in 2002 and made open source in 2018. I've been using it on Mac and iPhone for several years now and I'm finding it indispensable. Via Lobste.rs Tags: `brent-simmons`, `netnewswire`, `open-source`

4. Verizon, Formerly Menace Mobile

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-19T00:58:25Z

Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lzmntndEXWo>

Verizon has sprung for a new ad campaign set in the Austin Powers world, with four stars from the cast ? Mike Myers, of course, as Dr. Evil; Rob Lowe as Number Two (Robert Wagner is alive but is 96); Seth Green as Evil's son Scott, and Mindy Sterling as Frau Farbissina ? and director Jay Roach. The premise of the two-minute spot is that Dr. Evil is proposing ?Menace Mobile?, a wireless carrier with confusing pricing and plans. Scott pooh-poohs the idea on the grounds that ?This isn't evil. This is just typical phone company stuff.? Then, after some back-and-forth, comes this exchange: Scott: Diabolical phone companies are why we're all switching to Verizon. Dr. Evil: I thought Verizon was just like the rest of the wireless organizations. Scott: Well, they were, but not anymore. They just got rid of activation and upgrade fees. They're changing everything. I don't think the commercial is particularly funny, alas, but I do find it extraordinary, because of the exchange quoted above. ?Well, they were, but not anymore? is one the most extraordinary lines I've heard in a commercial. They're just flat out admitting that, until recently, they ran their business like a scheme from Dr. Evi...

5. Cotypist ? Smart Autocomplete Utility for Mac

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-18T19:36:18Z

Link: <https://cotypist.app/>

Usually when I link to a new app, it's something that I find useful personally. Cotypist is something else. It's an AI-powered autocomplete utility for the Mac, using on-device models and processing, by developer Daniel Gr   of Accelerated Thought. It is very well-designed, and remarkably Mac-assed (right down to where it stores its local data and AI models). It respects your privacy and all the best conventions of MacOS. Cotypist suggests a few words ahead of your insertion point at a time, and you can accept them by hitting Tab; if you want to ignore them, you just keep typing. The autocomplete suggestions appear inline, in whatever app you're typing in, using your current font. I wasn't even aware that was possible, but it is via MacOS's rich accessibility APIs. Cotypist's suggestions are eerily good. It's even got a great name. Personally, I can't stand using it. For me, it's actually worse that the suggestions are so good, and so often on-point for what I intend to write. That's why I can't stand it. It's like having a voice in my ear whispering my own thoughts before I think them. But are they my thoughts, or are they just close to my thoughts? They're so close I can't tell...

6. New Domain for Sign In With Apple and iCloud+ Hide My Email

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-18T17:13:48Z

Link: <https://developer.apple.com/news/?id=sus6t6ab>

Apple Developer: Later this summer, Apple will unify the email domains used by Sign in with Apple and iCloud+ Hide My Email under a single, shared domain: private.icloud.com . New addresses generated for both features will be issued on the new domain. For example: Sign in with Apple addresses, previously issued on privaterelay.appleid.com , will be issued on private.icloud.com . iCloud+ Hide My Email addresses, previously issued on icloud.com , will be issued on private.icloud.com . Existing addresses on the legacy domains will continue to work and forward mail to users without interruption. Initial reaction to this change is that it might render ?Hide My Email? ineffective , because shitbird services will simply ban the domain, trying to force you to use your primary email address. It seems inevitable that some number of services will do this. But my retort is that a service that won't accept these email addresses is one that I probably don't want to have anything to do with. The only reason not to accept private.icloud.com email addresses is if you want to do something invasive with users' actual email addresses. ?

7. ?Popa? Botnet Linked to Publicly-Traded Israeli Firm

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Thu, 18 Jun 2026 17:37:58 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/06/popa-botnet-linked-to-publicly-traded-israeli-firm/>

For the past four years, a sprawling Android-based botnet called Popa has forced millions of consumer TV boxes to relay Internet traffic linked to advertising fraud, account takeovers, and mass data-scraping efforts. This week, researchers from multiple security firms concluded that the Popa botnet is linked to NetNut, a "residential proxy" provider operated by the publicly-traded Israeli firm Alarum Technologies Ltd [NASDAQ: ALAR].

8. Why doesn't GetLastInputInfo() return info for the user I'm impersonating?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 18 Jun 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260618-00/?p=112444>

It doesn't care about impersonation, says so on the tin. The post Why doesn't GetLastInputInfo() return info for the user I'm impersonating? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. Windows stack limit checking retrospective, follow-up

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 17 Jun 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260617-00/?p=112436>

Choosing the register to use to pass the desired stack allocation size. The post Windows stack limit checking retrospective, follow-up appeared first on The Old New Thing .

10. How to correctly not wait for network carrier in Netplan

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-06-18T02:03:05Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/linux/UbuntuNetplanWaitForCarrierII>

Yesterday I wrote an entry about why servers running Ubuntu can stall on boot for two minutes ; the short version is that in 26.04, a network interface that either has no carrier or that has nothing else on it will cause systemd-networkd-wait-online to wait for two minutes in the hopes that this changes and the interface becomes healthy. My core diagnosis of the trigger for the problem was correct, but I had the wrong fix because in my testing, I made a classic mistake that's only really possible with virtual networking for virtual machines. There's an often invisible difference between an isolated virtual network interface and one that has no carrier , and I tested with an isolated interface, which stalls under some circumstances and fixed by some things, but not a virtual machine network interface with no carrier . The latter requires a more thorough fix. I will put the answer at the front: you need to set every disconnected interface in your Netplan configuration to ' optional: true '. Setting ' ignore-carrier: true ' isn't necessarily sufficient unless the interface has carrier. If you're mangling your 26.04 Netplan configuration anyway, I suggest you also set ' accept-ra: fal...

11. I hate compilers

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Thu, 18 Jun 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/notes/2026/anubis-wasm-vendor-binary/>

You'd think that given the same bytes of input you'd get the same bytes of output. lol. Imao. No, you don't. It's complicated.

12. Book Review: The Great When by Alan Moore ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 18 Jun 2026 11:34:19 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/06/book-review-the-great-when-by-alan-moore/>

This is the most overwritten book I've ever read. Unfortunately, Alan Moore knows exactly how much polysyllabic pressure it takes to transmogrify base coal into precious gems. With lines like "his shaved suede skull made him look like a wilted thistle" and "There was a rumour of pink lipstick circling her mouth" you know you're in for a treat. Even better than the joyful prose of Bob?

13. Open Source vs the Invisible Hand

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-06-18T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/06/18/open-source-vs-the-invisible-hand.html>

If you handed an economics undergraduate a description of how open source libraries are produced, without saying what it was, and asked them to predict the outcome, they would tell you it doesn't add up. Non-excludable goods with no price, no contracts, no liability, a median producer headcount of one, and near-total free riding by consumers: there is no model in the textbook under which that arrangement produces anything stable. Then you run npm install and a few hundred of these impossible goods arrive in seconds, and the commercial software industry sits almost entirely on top of them. Open source breaks more or less the full set of market axioms at once. The free rider problem . A public good is non-rival (my use doesn't reduce yours) and non-excludable (you can't keep me out), and standard theory holds that such goods will be underproduced because every rational actor waits for someone else to pay. The canonical case is the lighthouse , where everyone benefits and nobody volunteers, so government has to build it. An open source library meets the definition exactly, being perfectly non-rival and non-excludable by licence, so the theory predicts a small number of them, grudging...

14. You don't understand, prices can't go down

Source: the singularity is nearer | Published: 2026-06-18T00:00:00-07:00

Link: <https://geohot.github.io/blog/jekyll/update/2026/06/18/prices-cant-go-down.html>

Since at least 2008, every time there's an option to either make the money track real value or make sure things don't go down, they chose the latter. As a result, money is increasingly

uncoupled from reality. From Cory Doctorow's blog : The actual dead economy risk is that our institutions and markets will continue to move capital from productive activity into memestocks, vibes, and bubbles. Theranos was ~\$10B, FTX was ~\$100B, and frontier AI lab is ~\$1T. The US government is ~\$10T. We are one order of magnitude from the end of too big to fail. If grassroots movements aren't totally captured and get serious, I have a very good solution . Every time someone is making money, you have to ask: is this created by growth? If the answer is no, the only other option is who did they take it from? Cruise Automation was founded around the same time as comma. They burned \$10B with nothing to show for it. There was clearly no growth, so who lost the \$10B? And don't stop at 'the investors' they are just middlemen. Trace it all the way through. Since 1980, the economy has grown at 2.6% per year. The stock market has grown at 12.3% per year. Compounded, that's 3.3x vs 220x. Does this make any sen...

15. GLM 5.2 playing text adventures

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Thu, 18 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/glm-5-2-playing-text-adventures>

I've heard some buzz around the new GLM 5.2 open-weights model. They say it's very capable! I won't run a full comparison benchmark, but I have some credits sloshing around on OpenRouter so I figured I might compare GLM 5.2 to the similarly-priced Gemini 3 Flash, and see where things land. This uses the same setup as the previous benchmark: each LLM gets a few attempts at playing the game, with each attempt being limited to a fixed budget of around \$0.15. The LLM doesn't know it, but the harness tracks achievements for each game, and counts how many the LLM earns in each attempt. Here are the number of attempts for each game in this run. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

16. Passive Voice Considered Harmful

Source: Refactoring English | Published: Fri, 31 Jan 2025 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://refactoringenglish.com/excerpts/passive-voice-considered-harmful/>

Your high school English teachers probably warned you that passive voice is dangerous and forbidden. Then, when you were an adult, some guy in a leather jacket told you that passive voice is cool and should be used whenever it's desired. Well, the tide has turned again. If you're a software developer, stop using the passive voice. Wait, what's passive voice? In English, sentences can have one of two structures: passive voice or active voice.

17. Rules for Writing Software Tutorials

Source: Refactoring English | Published: Thu, 02 Jan 2025 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://refactoringenglish.com/excerpts/rules-for-software-tutorials/>

Most software tutorials are tragically flawed. Tutorials often forget to mention some key detail, preventing readers from replicating the author's process. Other times, the author brings in hidden assumptions that don't match their readers' expectations. The good news is that it's easier than you think to write an exceptional software tutorial. You can stand out in a sea of mediocre guides by following a few simple rules. Rules Write for beginners Promise a clear outcome in the title Explain the goal in the introduction Show the end result Make code snippets copy/pasteable Use long versions of command-line flags Separate user-defined values from reusable logic Use unambiguous example values Spare the reader from mindless tasks Keep your code in a working state Teach one thing Don't try to look pretty Minimize dependencies Specify filenames clearly Use consistent, descriptive headings Demonstrate that your solution works Link to a complete example Write for beginners The most common mistake tutorials make is explaining beginner-level concepts using expert-level terminology.

18. Show your hands honor for the strange power they bring you

Source: Aresluna | Published: 2026-06-18T14:43:48+0000

Link: <https://aresluna.org/show-your-hands-honor>

On designing finger-friendly interactions. (7,700 words. 38 playgrounds.)

19. Pluralistic: AI digital sovereignty risk doesn't exist (18 Jun 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 18 Jun 2026 15:22:16

+0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/06/18/their-trillions-our-billions/>

Today's links AI digital sovereignty risk doesn't exist: If 'risk + AI = risk ? AI', then 'AI = 0'. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Napster x librarians; Flickr API reciprocity; KFC's Mega Jug v diabetes research; Hambone virtuoso; Google fiber x binding arbitration; "The Immortal Choir Holds Every Voice." Upcoming appearances: LA, Menlo Park, Toronto, NYC, Philadelphia, Chicago, London, Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. AI digital sovereignty risk doesn't exist (permalink) Back at the height of the blockchain bubble, I made a hobby of pointing out that crypto weirdos were palming a card. I used this formulation: if: problem + blockchain = problem ? blockchain then: blockchain = 0 <https://pluralistic.net/2022/01/30/the-inevitability-of-trusted-third-parties/> You see, blockchain weirdos kept insisting that they could solve problems related to trust and institutional design with "smart contracts." Rather than having to trust a board of directors to steer an orga...